THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 10

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

In a narrow lane of a Rajasthan town, an old potter named Hari Ram still turns his wheel at dawn. His hands, thick with clay, know how much pressure a pot needs before it begins to bend. His grandfather made pots, so did his father, and he has always thought that his son would one day do the same. But the son has gone to the city to work in a factory. 'The pot is cheaper than the plastic jug,' says Hari Ram, 'but nobody counts the hours.'

India has thousands of such crafts: weaving, block printing, pottery, metal work, wood carving and embroidery. For centuries they have fed families and given beauty to daily life. Today many of them are fading. Machines produce goods faster and cheaper; young people see little respect and little money in the old trades; and customers rarely stop to ask who made the cloth or the cup that they use.

Hari Ram's anxiety is shared by many craftspeople in India. Weavers, metal-workers and woodcarvers find that machine-made goods are cheaper and faster, and that young people prefer steady wages in a factory to the uncertainty of the market. Yet there is a growing group of buyers who value an object that carries the mark of a human hand. A pot with a slightly uneven rim, a shirt printed with wooden blocks and a toy carved by an artisan tell a story that no machine can print on a label.

If such skills are to survive, young people must see them as dignified and profitable. Training centres, fairs and online markets can help to connect artisans with buyers who will pay a fair price. Hari Ram's son may yet return, if he sees that his father's craft can feed a family, and if the town learns to be proud of its potter.

Yet there are signs of change. Some designers now work with village artisans and bring their patterns to a wider market. Online shops allow a weaver in a small town to sell directly to buyers in distant cities. Schools in some places invite craftspeople to teach children for a day, and the children return with clay under their nails and a new respect in their eyes.

What can a buyer do? Choose handmade goods when possible and pay a fair price. Ask where an item was made. Visit craft fairs. A craft survives only as long as someone is willing to buy its work and someone is willing to learn it. Both of these depend, in the end, on all of us.

(i) Hari Ram's son has gone to the city to: 1

(a) study **(b)** work in a factory

(c) sell pots **(d)** learn weaving

(ii) 'Nobody counts the hours' means: 1

(a) the potter works little **(b)** people do not value the time and skill that goes into the work

(c) pots are made quickly **(d)** customers are punctual

(iii) One reason why crafts are fading is that: 1

(a) there are no customers abroad **(b)** raw material is expensive

(c) machines make goods faster and cheaper **(d)** crafts are banned

(iv) How do online shops help artisans? 1

(a) They let artisans sell directly to distant buyers **(b)** They set prices

(c) They provide clay **(d)** They provide training

(v) A craft survives only as long as: 1

(a) the government exists **(b)** fairs are held

(c) machines are costly **(d)** there are buyers and learners

(vi) What kinds of crafts are named in the passage? Name two. 1

(vii) What do children gain when craftspeople visit their school? 1

(viii) What can a buyer do to help a craft survive? Mention one. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'skilled workers who make things by hand'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'becoming weaker or disappearing slowly'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Every winter, the district administration organises a handicraft fair on the grounds of the town hall to promote local craftspeople. This year, the organisers decided to keep a daily record of the sales and the number of stalls of each craft, so that they could plan the space and publicity for the next fair. On the first day, a small team of college volunteers noted down the figures at the end of the evening.

A craft fair recorded the stalls and sales of five types of handicrafts on its first day.

Craft	Number of stalls	Sales (₹)
Pottery	6	18,000
Block-printed cloth	8	40,000
Wood carving	4	24,000
Embroidery	5	25,000

The organisers observed that the number of stalls does not always decide the sales, because some crafts have higher prices than others. They also noted that school groups visited in large numbers during the morning, while families came in the evening. Craftspeople who attended the closing meeting asked for a stall near the entrance and for a facility to accept digital payments. The collector, who inaugurated the fair, said that artisans would be invited again next year and promised that the fee for stalls would be reduced for first-time participants.

(i) Which craft recorded the highest sales? 1

(a) Wood carving **(b)** Pottery

(c) Embroidery **(d)** Block-printed cloth

(ii) How many stalls were there in all? 1

(a) 19 **(b)** 21 **(c)** 25 **(d)** 23

(iii) What were the total sales on the first day? 1

(a) ₹ 1,07,000 **(b)** ₹ 90,000 **(c)** ₹ 1,00,000 **(d)** ₹ 1,17,000

(iv) What was the average sale per stall for wood carving? 1

(v) Which craft had the lowest sales? 1

(vi) How much more did block-printed cloth sell than pottery? 1

(vii) Which craft earned the same sales per stall as ₹ 5,000? 1

(viii) Suggest one way to attract more visitors to pottery stalls. 1

(ix) Why do fairs help craftspeople? 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'objects made by hand'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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